

Fariha Ahmed

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🌐 <https://www.linkedin.com/in/fariha-ahmed-8b784118a>

PROFILE

Master's student in Public Affairs with a concentration in Public Policy. Experienced in data-driven policy analysis, monitoring government initiatives, advocacy, and nonprofit program management. Adept at coordinating interdisciplinary initiatives, building stakeholder partnerships, and leading teams that advance equity and social impact for vulnerable populations.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, MOTPP Project (Missouri Teen Pregnancy Prevention) 08/2025 – Present
Institute of Public Policy (IPP), University of Missouri Columbia, Missouri, USA

- Supporting data management of approximately **500 participants**: cleaning datasets, coding variables, merging pre- and post- program survey data, and preparing data for statistical analysis for TOP SRAE (Sexual Risk Avoidance Education) and State Personal Responsibility Education Program (PREP)

Policy Research Associate 04/2025 – 06/2025
The Dacca Institute of Research and Analytics (DAIRA) Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Conducted research and developed a policy paper analyzing the reports from the Reform Commissions under the Interim Government of Bangladesh, assessing key recommendations and proposing frameworks for implementation
- Presented findings to political stakeholders and experts, facilitating discussion and feedback to refine reform proposals (Experts call for concrete steps to implement reform commission reports | The Daily Star 🌐)

Research Assistant 07/2024 – 10/2024
South Asian Institute of Policy and Governance (SIPG), North South University Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Developed detailed reports on how the Rohingya migrant issue is addressed in multilateral forums, analyzing policy resolutions.
- Assisted principal investigators develop the questionnaire for the nationwide survey on "Citizens' Expectations from the Interim Government of Bangladesh."
- Coded the survey on KoboToolBox and training enumerators

Project Manager and Field Associate 09/2023 – 06/2024
Give Bangladesh Foundation Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Led a team on a water sustainability project to create plans adaptive to the climate and local needs of coastal areas, hill tracts, and the northern region. The project addressed the issues of salinity and shrinking water resources and has been able to provide drinkable water for approximately **30,000 people**.
- Managed a team of 60 volunteers for Project Kombol, overseeing fundraising efforts, partner collaboration, and social media communications. This initiative supported marginalized communities in the northern region, helping around **1,500 individuals**.

EDUCATION

Master's in Public Affairs (MPA) 08/2025 – 05/2027
University of Missouri-Columbia Missouri, USA
CGPA: 4.00/4.00 (through Spring 2026)

Bachelor of Social Science in Development Studies 01/2019 – 08/2023
University of Dhaka Dhaka, Bangladesh
[Ranked 1st in the Faculty of Social Sciences, CGPA: 3.99/4.00]
Focus: Social policy, microeconomics, macroeconomics, development economics, political science

ORGANIZATIONS

Give Bangladesh Foundation

Volunteer

12/2020 – 08/2023

Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Designed and implemented programs supporting vulnerable groups, including sex workers, children, farmers, and tiger widows in the mangrove forest region.
- Developed grant proposals and managed the organization's fundraising initiatives.
- Created impactful social media content by writing narratives based on community interviews and later trained a team of writers to continue this work.
- Assisted in emergency response campaigns across multiple districts of Bangladesh during crises such as the nationwide floods of 2022.

TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

Survey Programming — KoboToolBox, **Statistical Analysis** — STATA, Excel, **Design** — Canva, PowerPoint

AWARDS, HONORS AND FUNDING

Full Tuition Waiver and Graduate Assistantship

2025

Truman School of Government & Public Affairs, University of Missouri

Recipient, Dean's Award for Academic Excellence

2023

Faculty of Social Sciences, University of Dhaka

Champion, Devthon 3.0: Development Case Competition

2022

The Asia Foundation

A national-level inter-university case competition focusing on macro-level development issues.

The Bangladesh Bank Governor's Scholarship for Academic Excellence

2022

University of Dhaka, Bangladesh

Awarded in 2022, 2021, and 2019 for consistently outstanding academic performance. The scholarship provides financial support to undergraduate students who maintain exceptional results.

LANGUAGES

Bengali: Native

English: Advanced (C1)

Oral Language Assessment, EPI score: 4/4

REFERENCES

Kathleen Miller, Associate Professor, University of Missouri

MillerKK@missouri.edu

Angela M. Hull, Associate Professor, University of Missouri

HullAM@missouri.edu

PUBLICATIONS

Determinants of Institutional Trust in South Asia: A Mixed-Methods Study of Cultural Values and State Religious Constraints

Presented in the Lightning talk session at the 83rd Annual Midwest Political Science Association Conference, Chicago, IL, 2026.